

sities and encouraging interchange between universities. In order to accomplish this, we will strive to establish associations among the national universities which will allow transfers of credit, exchanges of faculty members, and the implementation of a common entrance examination.

DEMOCRATIC SOCIALIST PARTY (DSP) 33:79
SASAKI, CHAIRMAN

1. Tax Increase

The general consumption tax has a number of problems: 1) it is a regressive tax for it places a heavy burden on those in the lower income brackets, 2) it will increase the danger of a sudden jump in prices, and 3) it will significantly increase the burden on small and medium sized businessman and small shopkeepers. We are therefore resolutely opposed to its introduction. We will strive for a thorough reform of administration that will include the consolidation and reorganization of public corporations and government enterprises, the abolishment of the regional finance bureaus and other local agencies of the central government, and the reshuffle of public officials as well as introducing an age-limit system.

We will strive for a financial reconstruction based on the abolishment of the favorable tax treatment of interest and dividend income, on the correction of the unfair tax system by strengthening among other items the separate tax on entertainment expenses, on a 2 percent increase in the tax rate of

corporations, on the establishment of a new tax on wealth, and on natural increases in tax revenue.

2. Inflation and Energy

In order to limit to the extent possible the effects of price increases of natural resources on domestic prices, we will control price gouging and designate certain commodities to come under a law to prevent hoarding and cornering of petroleum products. We will invoke promptly the revised Anti-Monopoly Law and prevent in advance increases by cartels and small number of large corporations which are not part of a price cartel but nevertheless act in concert.

We regard as a goal a 15 percent decrease in energy consumption for fiscal 1985. We will promote a comprehensive energy policy based on measures of special energy payments. We will strengthen the function of the nuclear power safety committee and establish a cycle of nuclear fuel. We will strive to actively utilize domestic coal based on the development of technology to liquefy coal and convert it into natural gas. We will enact laws to encourage the development of new energy sources, such as solar and thermal power.

3. Correction of Political Corruption

The source of political corruption lies in the so-called "1955 political system," which is based on the union of the political world, the bureaucracy, and big business. This union was brought about both by the long administrative rule of the LDP

and by the irresponsibility of part of the political opposition to permit this. We will defeat the LDP in the general election, and along with thoroughly investigating the political responsibility of the suspicious aircraft dealings, we will strive to build a foundation of alternating power by dramatically advancing the power of responsible political opposition parties centered around the DSP.

We will strengthen administrative supervision by establishing an ombudsmen system (specialists in overseeing administration), by enacting a public information law, by making elections managed publicly, and by aiming for "open, participatory, and responsible" politics where all political funds of individual Dietmen are open to public scrutiny.

4. Welfare and Expenditures

We will realize a high level of welfare through equitable burdens. Along with standardizing the level of medical payments to the beneficiary and his family and abolishing payments outside the coverage of medical insurance such as the the payment of the difference in the prices of beds, we will return medical insurance to financial soundness by making more equitable the system of partial payments.

In order to change the currently low level of benefits of old age welfare pensions, five-year pensions, and other types of pensions, we will establish a basic pension system. We will erect a rich welfare state that will raise the standard of

living.

5. Diplomacy and Defense

In order to fulfill our international duty as a member of the free world, we will actively promote aid to Indochinese refugees and expand economic cooperation. Besides pushing for the return of the four islands of the Northern Territories, we oppose the building of Soviet military bases on the islands.

In order not to be held in contempt by other countries, we must, as an independent country, be fully provided with the necessary ability to defend ourselves to complement the Japan-U.S. Security Treaty. We want to establish a defense committee in the Diet and build a national consensus for defense.

6. Education

We will take measures to reduce subsidies to schools with unfair entrance examinations. We will correct education which is centered on examinations by promoting lifetime education, the participation of private universities in the first round common entrance examination, and the revision of second round examinations so that they consider primarily aptitude and character. We will push for education that nurtures individuality and ability by improving the uniform education methods and upgrading the quality of teachers.

We will realize the government subsidization of one half of the operating costs of private schools, the expansion of the scholarship system, as well as other means to reduce the the bur-

den of educational expenses.

JAPAN COMMUNIST PARTY (JCP) 54:79
MIYAMOTO, CHAIRMAN

1. Tax Increase

We are absolutely against heavy taxes on the people. We will tax big capital which currently receive reductions in and exemptions from taxes. The LDP is shelving its responsibility, and we plan to end plans for the 28 trillion tax increase over 5 years which will tax heavily the lower and middle level income levels and for the general consumption tax which will hurt the people and tiny, small, and medium sized businesses. We can secure new revenues of 2 trillion yen from making radical corrections in the terribly unfair tax system, which favors large capital and the wealthy, and 2 trillion yen by reducing nonessential expenses such as those to large corporations and the military.

In this way, family finances will not be squeezed, and we can reduce the issue of national bonds and make progress in financial reconstruction.

2. Inflation and Energy

We will stop the Ohira Cabinet's hands-off policy of not intervening in prices at the lowest level, and we will stop price gouging in kerosene and other petroleum products by invoking the oil supply rationalization law. We can stabilize oil prices if we strengthen the Anti-Monopoly Law and adopt such policies as controlling monopolistic prices by making costs public.